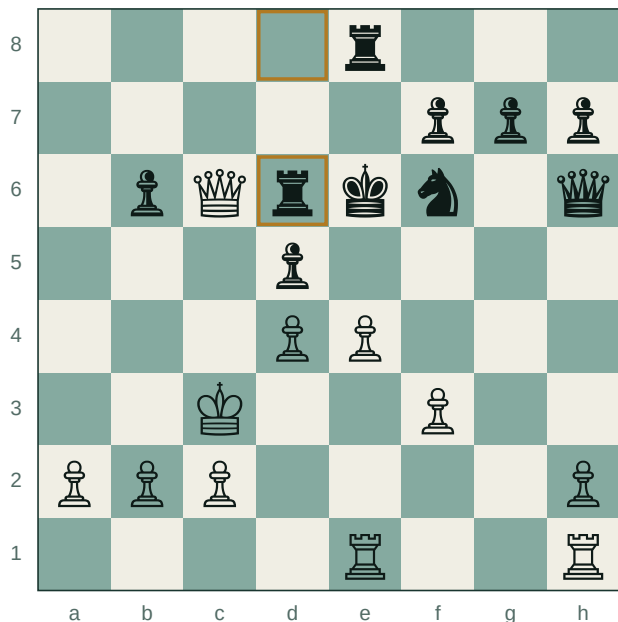


Double checks: White, move 22

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 21...Rd6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

22. exd5+ Kf5 23. Qxd6 Rxe1 24. Rxe1

22.exd5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the rook on e1 attacks the king on e6. Recorded reply: **22...Kf5**.

23.Qxd6 The queen captures the rook on d6. Recorded reply: **23...Rxe1**.

24.Rxe1 The rook captures the rook on e1.

At the end, nominal material is White 21 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -1 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on e6. Absolute pin: rook on d6.